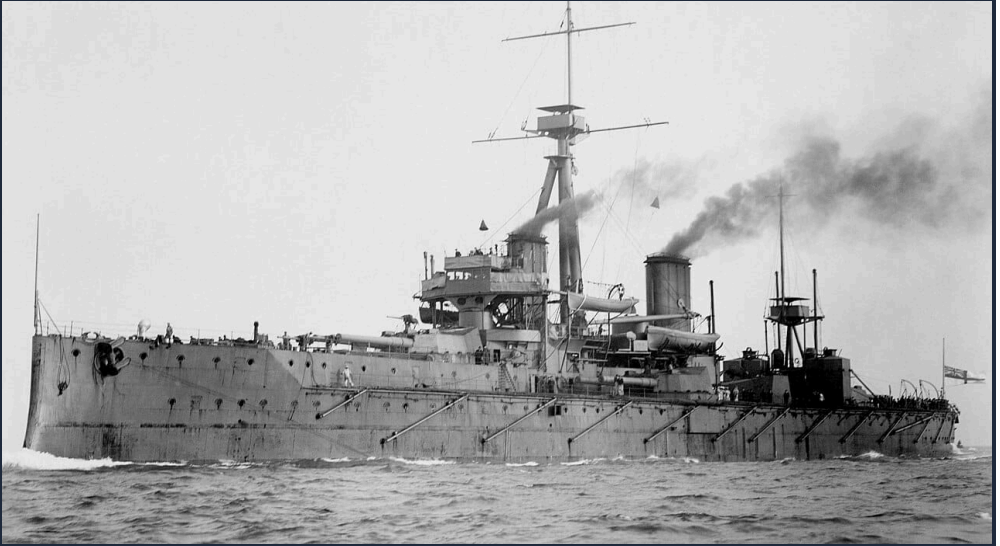




KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL VAULT • HOMEWORK COMPANION

How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?

KS3 HISTORY • CAUSES OF THE GREAT WAR (1871–1914)

Scholar: _____

Class / Form: _____

History Teacher: _____

Mr Lovett

**Mobile Digital Answer Key:**

Scan with your phone camera for the interactive mobile quiz and instant parent answer key.

FORMATIVE HOMEWORK & RETRIEVAL LEDGER

Spaced Retrieval Cycle • Read, Cover, Write, Check & Retest

TRACKING MATRIX

Instructions for Scholars & Parents: Complete **Attempt 1** from memory without looking at the back. Self-mark using *The Explanation* on Pages 5–6. Review your errors, then complete **Attempt 2** two days later to achieve long-term mastery.

LESSON & FOCUS TOPIC	DUE DATE	ATTEMPT 1	ATTEMPT 2	PARENT	RAG
1. German Unification (1871) & Bismarck	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	
2. Franco-Prussian War & Revanche	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	
3. The Scramble for Africa & Morocco	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	
4. Naval Arms Race & HMS Dreadnought	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	
5. The Alliance System (Triple Entente)	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	
6. Sarajevo Assassination & July Crisis	__ / __	/ 8	/ 8	[]	

Unit Mastery Target: 42+ / 48 (87%+) • Level 4 Factual Fluency

Final Score: ____ / 48

Teacher Verification & Feedback Stamp:

Signature & Date

1. GERMAN UNIFICATION (1871) & BISMARCK'S ALLIANCES

- ☐ 1. How many independent states existed in Central Europe before German unification?
- ☐ 2. Which powerful military kingdom led the unification of Germany?
- ☐ 3. Who was the Prussian Chancellor who engineered the unification of Germany?
- ☐ 4. In what year was the German Empire officially proclaimed?
- ☐ 5. Where was King Wilhelm I of Prussia crowned as the first German Emperor?
- ☐ 6. What was Bismarck's primary foreign policy goal after 1871?
- ☐ 7. What was Germany's greatest strategic military nightmare?
- ☐ 8. What secret 1887 agreement did Bismarck negotiate to keep Russia neutral?

2. THE FRANCO-PRUSSIAN WAR & THE LEGACY OF REVANCHE

- ☐ 9. Which French territory was annexed by Germany following the war in 1871?
- ☐ 10. What was the French national desire for vengeance called?
- ☐ 11. What was the size of the financial indemnity France was forced to pay Germany in 1871?
- ☐ 12. Which treaty formally concluded the Franco-Prussian War in May 1871?
- ☐ 13. Which French Emperor was captured by Prussian forces at the Battle of Sedan (1870)?
- ☐ 14. Which ambitious young Emperor took the German throne in 1888 and dismissed Bismarck in 1890?
- ☐ 15. What catastrophic diplomatic decision did Wilhelm II make immediately after dismissing Bismarck?
- ☐ 16. What historic military alliance was signed in 1894 as a direct result of Wilhelm II's blunder?

3. THE SCRAMBLE FOR AFRICA & THE MOROCCAN CRISES

- ☐ 17. What term describes the rapid partition of the African continent by European empires (1881–1914)?
- ☐ 18. Which 1884–85 conference laid down the imperial ground rules for annexing African territory?
- ☐ 19. What famous slogan expressed Kaiser Wilhelm II's demand for a German colonial empire?
- ☐ 20. What was Kaiser Wilhelm II's aggressive global foreign policy called?
- ☐ 21. Where did Kaiser Wilhelm II land in 1905 to provoke the First Moroccan Crisis?
- ☐ 22. Which 1906 conference resolved the First Moroccan Crisis, resulting in a diplomatic humiliation for Germany?
- ☐ 23. What military action sparked the Second Moroccan Crisis (Agadir Crisis) in 1911?
- ☐ 24. What was the decisive strategic consequence of the two Moroccan Crises for Anglo-French relations?

4. THE ANGLO-GERMAN NAVAL ARMS RACE & HMS DREADNOUGHT

- ☐ 25. Which revolutionary, all-big-gun British battleship was launched in 1906?
- ☐ 26. Which German naval minister directed the rapid construction of the German High Seas Fleet?
- ☐ 27. What traditional maritime doctrine required Britain's fleet to equal the combined strength of the next two largest navies?
- ☐ 28. What was Admiral Tirpitz's 'Risk Theory' (Risikotheorie)?
- ☐ 29. What popular public slogan erupted across Britain in 1909 demanding accelerated battleship construction?
- ☐ 30. Why did Britain view Germany's naval expansion as an existential and hostile threat?
- ☐ 31. By the outbreak of war in August 1914, who had won the dreadnought naval race?
- ☐ 32. What was the lasting geopolitical impact of the naval race on Britain's foreign policy?

5. THE ALLIANCE SYSTEM: TRIPLE ENTENTE VS TRIPLE ALLIANCE

- ☐ 33. Which three empires made up the Triple Alliance formed in 1882?
- ☐ 34. Which three nations formed the Triple Entente by 1907?
- ☐ 35. What was Britain's long-standing 19th-century policy of avoiding continental European alliances called?
- ☐ 36. What friendly diplomatic accord did Britain and France sign in 1904?
- ☐ 37. What 1907 agreement settled colonial rivalries in Persia, Tibet, and Afghanistan, completing the Triple Entente?
- ☐ 38. Why was Italy widely viewed as the 'weak link' in the Triple Alliance?
- ☐ 39. What was the fatal structural flaw of the European alliance system?
- ☐ 40. Why was south-eastern Europe known as the 'Powder Keg of Europe'?

6. THE SARAJEVO ASSASSINATION, JULY CRISIS & WAR

- ☐ 41. On what exact date was Archduke Franz Ferdinand assassinated in Sarajevo?
- ☐ 42. Who was the 19-year-old Bosnian Serb nationalist who fired the fatal shots?
- ☐ 43. What clandestine Serbian military terrorist organisation trained and armed the assassins?
- ☐ 44. Why did Austria-Hungary's annexation of Bosnia in 1908 cause fury in Serbia?
- ☐ 45. What was Germany's famous 'Blank Cheque' issued on 5–6 July 1914?
- ☐ 46. What diplomatic document did Austria-Hungary deliver to Serbia on 23 July 1914?
- ☐ 47. What was the German war strategy designed to prevent a prolonged two-front war?
- ☐ 48. Why did Great Britain officially declare war on Germany at 11:00 pm on 4 August 1914?

THE EXPLANATION & MARKING BANK (PART 1)

Lessons 1 to 3 • Answers 1 to 24 • Causal Understanding

MARK SCHEME 1-24

1. GERMAN UNIFICATION (1871) & BISMARCK'S ALLIANCES

1. **39 independent states** — Prior to 1871, the German states were loosely connected in the German Confederation, dominated by Prussia and Austria. [✓][X]
2. **Prussia** — Prussia used its disciplined military, advanced railway network, and Krupp steel industry to unite the German states under Berlin. [✓][X]
3. **Otto von Bismarck** — Bismarck used a pragmatic policy of 'Blood and Iron' (Realpolitik) and three swift wars to achieve unification. [✓][X]
4. **1871** — The Empire was proclaimed following Prussia's crushing victory over France in the Franco-Prussian War. [✓][X]
5. **The Hall of Mirrors at Versailles** — Staging the coronation inside the historic palace of the French monarchy was a calculated insult that deepened French hatred. [✓][X]
6. **To isolate France and maintain European peace** — Bismarck knew a revanchist France could never be reconciled, so he built alliances to deny France any military partners. [✓][X]
7. **A war on two fronts (Encirclement)** — Germany feared being simultaneously attacked by France from the west and Russia from the east, dividing its armed forces. [✓][X]
8. **The Reinsurance Treaty** — Both powers promised neutrality unless Germany attacked France or Russia attacked Germany's ally, Austria-Hungary. [✓][X]

2. THE FRANCO-PRUSSIAN WAR & THE LEGACY OF REVANCHE

9. **Alsace-Lorraine** — Germany seized this mineral-rich border territory for defence and industry, creating an enduring French determination to reclaim it. [✓][X]
10. **Revanche (Revanchism)** — French school textbooks, maps (veiled in black), and politicians kept the loss of Alsace-Lorraine alive as an open wound. [✓][X]
11. **5 billion gold francs** — Germany intended the indemnity to cripple France economically for a generation, though France paid it off ahead of schedule. [✓][X]
12. **The Treaty of Frankfurt** — The treaty codified the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine, the indemnity, and German military occupation until payment was complete. [✓][X]
13. **Napoleon III** — His capture brought the immediate collapse of the French Second Empire and the proclamation of the French Third Republic. [✓][X]
14. **Kaiser Wilhelm II** — Wilhelm II rejected Bismarck's cautious European diplomacy in favour of personal autocratic rule and aggressive global expansion. [✓][X]
15. **He allowed the Reinsurance Treaty with Russia to lapse** — This alienated Tsar Alexander III and left Russia diplomatically isolated and seeking new European partners. [✓][X]
16. **The Franco-Russian Military Alliance** — Autocratic Russia and republican France united militarily, realizing Bismarck's worst nightmare of a two-front encirclement. [✓][X]

3. THE SCRAMBLE FOR AFRICA & THE MOROCCAN CRISES

17. **The Scramble for Africa** — European powers colonised 90% of Africa in search of raw industrial materials, prestige, and captive colonial markets. [✓][X]
18. **The Berlin Conference** — Hosted by Bismarck, it established the principle of 'effective occupation' to prevent European wars over African land. [✓][X]
19. **A 'place in the sun' (Platz an der Sonne)** — Wilhelm II argued that Germany's massive industrial and military power entitled it to a worldwide overseas empire matching Britain's. [✓][X]
20. **Weltpolitik (World Policy)** — Weltpolitik abandoned Bismarck's continental focus and sought global naval, colonial, and commercial dominance. [✓][X]
21. **Tangier** — He delivered a fiery speech backing the Moroccan Sultan to challenge French dominance and test the strength of the Anglo-French Entente. [✓][X]
22. **The Algeiras Conference** — Only Austria-Hungary supported Germany; Britain, Russia, and Italy stood firmly with France, cementing German isolation. [✓][X]

THE EXPLANATION & MARKING BANK (PART 2)

Lessons 4 to 6 • Answers 25 to 48 • Causal Understanding

MARK SCHEME 25–48

4. THE ANGLO-GERMAN NAVAL ARMS RACE & HMS DREADNOUGHT

- 25. HMS Dreadnought** — *Dreadnought featured ten 12-inch guns and turbine propulsion, making every existing battleship on the planet instantly obsolete.* [✓][X]
- 26. Admiral Alfred von Tirpitz** — *Tirpitz passed the German Naval Laws (1898, 1900) to construct a fleet capable of challenging the British Royal Navy in the North Sea.* [✓][X]
- 27. The Two-Power Standard** — *Established by the Naval Defence Act 1889, Britain viewed naval supremacy as strictly vital for its food supply and empire.* [✓][X]
- 28. To build a navy so strong that Britain would not risk a battle for fear of crippling itself** — *Tirpitz believed this would force Britain to make diplomatic concessions and grant Germany colonial territory.* [✓][X]
- 29. "We want eight and we won't wait!"** — *Public panic over German shipyard expansion forced the British government to double dreadnought production from 4 to 8 ships.* [✓][X]
- 30. Because Britain was an island dependent on oceanic food imports, while Germany was already a land superpower** — *Winston Churchill described the German fleet as an aggressive 'luxury', while the Royal Navy was a defensive necessity.* [✓][X]
- 31. Britain (29 Dreadnoughts to Germany's 17)** — *Britain's overwhelming industrial capacity, financial wealth, and political consensus decisively outbuilt the German Empire.* [✓][X]
- 32. It permanently ended Britain's 'Splendid Isolation' and bound it to France and Russia** — *Realising it could not defend its empire alone against rising German power, Britain settled its historic rivalries.* [✓][X]

5. THE ALLIANCE SYSTEM: TRIPLE ENTENTE VS TRIPLE ALLIANCE

- 33. Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy** — *A mutual defensive pact promising assistance if attacked by France or other powers, though Italy remained a reluctant partner.* [✓][X]
- 34. Britain, France, and Russia** — *Formed through the 1894 Franco-Russian Alliance, 1904 Entente Cordiale, and 1907 Anglo-Russian Convention.* [✓][X]
- 35. Splendid Isolation** — *Britain focused on its worldwide empire and maintaining the naval balance of power without entangling continental treaties.* [✓][X]
- 36. The Entente Cordiale** — *It resolved colonial disputes (Britain in Egypt, France in Morocco) and paved the way for close diplomatic cooperation.* [✓][X]
- 37. The Anglo-Russian Convention** — *It ended the century-long 'Great Game' of imperial competition in Asia, clearing the path for joint European alignment.* [✓][X]
- 38. Italy held deep territorial rivalries with its alliance partner, Austria-Hungary** — *Italy coveted Italia Irredenta (Trentino and Trieste) ruled by Vienna, leading Italy to declare neutrality in 1914 and switch sides in 1915.* [✓][X]
- 39. A localized regional quarrel could instantly trigger a continent-wide chain reaction** — *Pledges of mutual defence meant empires felt compelled to mobilise armies to protect partners, converting a Balkan crisis into World War.* [✓][X]
- 40. The collapse of the Ottoman Empire created intense Slavic nationalism and imperial rivalries** — *Austria-Hungary and Russia both competed to dominate newly independent Balkan states like Serbia, creating constant crises.* [✓][X]

6. THE SARAJEVO ASSASSINATION, JULY CRISIS & WAR

- 41. 28 June 1914** — *The Archduke, heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne, was visiting the Bosnian capital on Vidovdan (St Vitus' Day), a Serbian national holiday.* [✓][X]
- 42. Gavrilo Princip** — *Princip was a member of Young Bosnia, a revolutionary student movement seeking to unite South Slavs into a Greater Serbia.* [✓][X]
- 43. The Black Hand (Union or Death)** — *Led by Colonel Dragutin Dimitrijević ('Apis'), head of Serbian military intelligence, who smuggled weapons and bombs across the border.* [✓][X]
- 44. Bosnia contained a large ethnic Serb population that Serbia wanted to incorporate into a Greater Serbian state** — *The 1908 Bosnian Crisis humiliated Serbia and its protector Russia, establishing a bitter blood-feud with Vienna.* [✓][X]

MASTER CHRONOLOGY DOMINO FLOWCHART

1871–1914 • The 11 Anchor Flashpoints of the Outbreak of War

TIMELINE

1871

German Empire Proclaimed: Unified in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles; Alsace-Lorraine annexed from France, sparking *Revanche*.

1882

Triple Alliance Formed: Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy create a central defensive bloc.

1890

Bismarck Dismissed: Kaiser Wilhelm II rejects defensive diplomacy, cancels the Reinsurance Treaty, and launches *Weltpolitik*.

1894

Franco-Russian Alliance: France and Russia unite militarily, trapping Germany between two rival powers (Encirclement).

1904

Entente Cordiale Signed: Britain and France settle colonial disputes and begin joint defensive talks.

1905

First Moroccan Crisis: Wilhelm II challenges French control in Tangier; Algeciras Conference (1906) isolates Germany.

1906

HMS Dreadnought Launched: Britain resets naval technology; sparks rapid arms race with Tirpitz's High Seas Fleet.

1907

Triple Entente Formed: Anglo-Russian Convention unites Britain, France, and Russia.

1908

Bosnian Crisis: Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia, permanently alienating Serbia and Russia.

28 June 1914

Sarajevo Assassination: Archduke Franz Ferdinand murdered by Gavrilo Princip (Black Hand); sparks July Crisis.

4 August 1914

Outbreak of World War: Germany enacts the Schlieffen Plan via neutral Belgium; Britain declares war.

Weltpolitik [Velt-pol-ee-teek] (GERMAN) "World Policy." Kaiser Wilhelm II's aggressive foreign policy to transform Germany into a global superpower with an overseas empire and massive battlefleet.
Revanche [Ruh-vahnsh] (FRENCH) "Revenge." The profound, enduring French national desire to avenge their humiliating defeat in the Franco-Prussian War (1870–71) and reclaim Alsace-Lorraine.
Einkreisung (Encirclement) [Ine-kry-zoong] (GERMAN) The persistent German strategic fear of being geographically surrounded and overwhelmed by a hostile Franco-Russian alliance on two fronts.
HMS Dreadnought [Dred-nawt] (ENGLISH) The revolutionary 1906 British battleship that rendered all older warships obsolete overnight and triggered a massive naval arms race with Germany.
Blank Cheque (Blankoscheck) [Blahnk-oh-sheck] (GERMAN) Germany's unconditional pledge of military backing issued to Austria-Hungary on 5–6 July 1914, emboldening Vienna to issue its crushing ultimatum to Serbia.
Schlieffen Plan [Shlee-fen Plan] (GERMAN) German war plan to rapidly invade France through neutral Belgium, capture Paris in 6 weeks, then transfer troops by rail to defeat Russia.
Mobilisation [Moh-bi-ly-zay-shun] (MILITARY) The complex, timetable-driven railway movement of millions of reservist troops and supplies to frontiers; once ordered, it made war virtually unstoppable.
The Powder Keg of Europe (METAPHOR) The volatile Balkan peninsula where competing ethnic Slavic nationalisms and Austro-Russian imperial ambitions threatened to explode at any moment.